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GAMING



Apple News+ adds a new game that uses emoji and Genmoji to solve puzzles



Sarah Perez — 9:00 PM PDT · July 16, 2025

Apple is introducing a new reason to upgrade to its subscription news offering, Apple News+: more games. On Thursday, the company [announced](#) the addition of the Emoji Game, an original title that will join its other games, including its Crossword puzzle, Crossword Mini, Sudoku, and word game [Quartiles](#), in both the U.S. and Canada in English.

Bundling games with other services has proven a successful strategy to attract users and keep them engaged, as [The New York Times](#) and even [LinkedIn](#) have discovered. Apple won't share its user numbers around Games, but it says that many people subscribe to News+ just for the puzzles.

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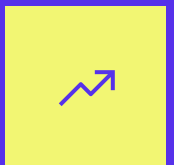
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IMAGE CREDITS:APPLE

Released to coincide with [World Emoji Day](#), the new Emoji Game is part logic, part word game that's inspired by how we use emojis to communicate with one another. In this daily game, players try to solve phrases using emojis with the goal of completing the puzzle in the least number of moves possible.

For instance, if the word “appear” showed up in the puzzle, you might see the letters “ap” followed by four blank spaces. Then you’d drag the emoji for the pear up into the blanks to complete the word. Of course, the phrases in the Emoji Game will be a bit harder to guess. Plus, the emoji you need to solve the puzzle will often be found in emoji combinations or those that involve a bit of abstract thinking to

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come up with the answer. The word for the emoji may also be used to fill in blank spaces that have other letters in between them.

If you're stumped, you can unveil a clue below the phrase, but this will cost you one of your moves.



IMAGE CREDITS:APPLE

There are multiple phrases to solve each day to complete the full puzzle. Finishing in six moves is considered a perfect score, and leaderboards help you track your streaks and how your scores compare with friends and other users. In the upcoming iOS 26, you'll be able to challenge friends to play with you using the new Games app.

To make the game more Apple-specific, it also leverages the recently introduced [Genmoji](#), or the custom emojis that are created using [Apple Intelligence](#), the company's AI. This expands the emojis available beyond the fewer than 2,000 that ship with your emoji keyboard. For instance, you might see a Genmoji of a blender and an emoji of a tomato to make the word "purée."



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The game is built by Apple, and puzzles are designed in partnership with a third party, [The Puzzle Society](#) (now [GoComics](#)). The game is also edited by Apple puzzle editors. It's rolling out now to Apple News+ subscribers in the U.S. and Canada on iPhone, iPad, and Mac. (Users on iOS 18.4 and later won't need to update their app to gain access to the game, but those on older versions will.)

The News+ subscription also comes with access to over 400 premium publishers, narrated audio, local news, sports, and, most recently, a [recipe-saving feature, Apple News+ Food](#).





Sarah Perez

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Sarah has worked as a reporter for TechCrunch since August 2011. She joined the company after having...

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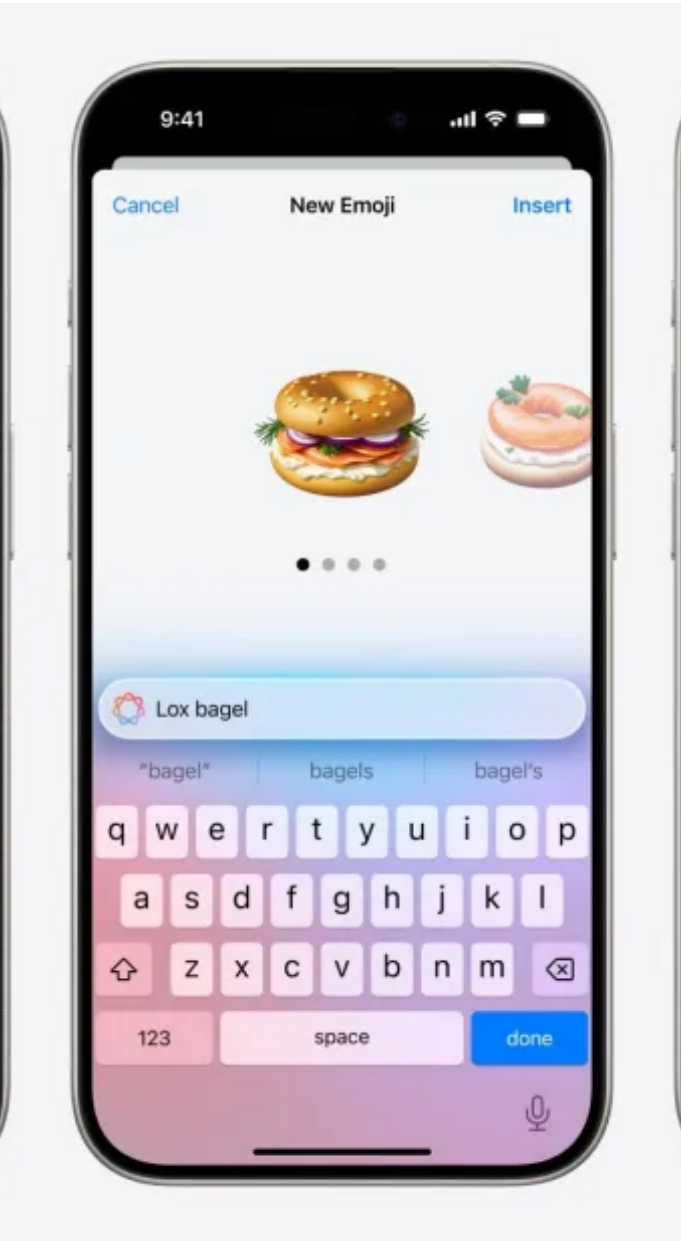


IMAGE CREDITS: APPLE

AI



Here’s how to create a custom emoji with the Apple Intelligence feature Genmoji

Lauren Forristal — 6:55 AM PST · December 11, 2024

Apple's [latest iOS 18.1 software update](#) introduced a series of Apple Intelligence features, including Writing Tools and notification summaries. However, some features were missing from the lineup, like Genmoji, which allows users to create emojis from written prompts.

Now, [with iOS 18.2, iPadOS 18.2, and macOS Sequoia 15.2 officially available](#), the highly anticipated AI-generated Bitmoji feature is finally here for users to try. It was previously only available as a [public beta](#).

Here's what you need to know about the Apple Intelligence feature that many people are excited about.

What is a Genmoji?

Genmoji initially debuted at [WWDC 2024](#) back in June. Built into the iPhone's emoji keyboard, the feature lets people generate original emojis with prompts. For example, "A sloth wearing a suit and tie." It can also generate emojis of people using photos. Genmojis can be used not only in Messages but also in Stickers and Tapbacks. It's also possible to react to a message with a Genmoji or with Apple's message effects.

How to create a customized emoji with Apple Intelligence

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When is the official launch of Genmoji?

Genmoji is currently available with Apple's iOS 18.2 update.

What Apple devices support Genmoji?

- iPhone 15 Pro
- iPhone 15 Pro Max
- iPhone 16
- iPhone 16 Plus
- iPhone 16 Pro
- iPhone 16 Max
- iPad mini with A17 Pro chip
- All iPads with an Apple silicon chip
- macOS Sequoia support coming soon

Is Apple Intelligence supported in my country?

The only regions where Apple Intelligence is not supported are China and the EU because of certain regulations.

Regarding language support, it's currently available in U.S. English and has started to roll out localized English support for users in Australia, Canada, New Zealand, South Africa, and the U.K.

By 2025, Chinese, English (India), English (Singapore), French, German, Italian, Japanese, Korean, Portuguese, Spanish, and Vietnamese will also become available.

This story was updated after its initial publication.

Topics: [AI](#) [Apple](#) [Apple Intelligence](#) [evergreens](#)

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Lauren Forristal



Lauren covers media, streaming, apps and platforms at TechCrunch.

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Apple's public betas for
iOS 18 are here to test out

Apple released the public betas for its next generation of software on the iPhone, Mac, iPad and Apple Watch on Monday. You can now test out iOS 18 and many of its new features, [except for Apple Intelligence](#), which is coming to beta this fall, and provide feedback to Apple.

Anyone interested in trying out Apple's upcoming software upgrades can sign up for the [Apple Beta Software Program](#) on its website. There you can enroll your device to access early versions of these features. iOS 18 includes several new customization options for your Home Screen. For instance, you can now place app icons and widgets wherever you'd like on your iOS Home Screen, and give all of them a colored tint.

Other features you can check out in the iOS 18 beta is the iPhone's completely new layout for the Photos app. The Messages app is also getting new features, including the ability to use Tapbacks with any emoji or sticker you'd like. In Wallet, the iOS 18 beta will allow early access to Tap to Cash, where Apple users can touch devices together to make in-person payments.

Once you're finished trying out the iOS 18 beta, you can restore a previously released OS version by following Apple's instructions [here](#). The company notes you can only roll back to an older software on the iPhone, iPad and Mac. You'll have to stick with

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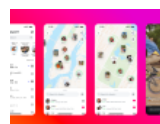
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the beta version on the Apple Watch until iOS 18 officially rolls out in the fall.

One feature we’re particularly excited to try in the iOS 18 beta is the ability to say “yes” or “no” to Siri by nodding your head while wearing AirPods Pros (you’ll need the 2nd generation for this one). This feature was unveiled during Apple’s Worldwide Developer’s Conference in June.

Another feature that caught everyone’s attention during WWDC was Apple Intelligence, the iPhone maker’s answer to our current AI craze. It will not be available in today’s public beta release. When it does come out, it will be limited to the iPhone 15 Pro and Pro Max.

[Without Apple Intelligence, iOS 18 beta feels like a TV show that’s waiting for the finale](#)

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